Important Update

2026-09-14 00:00:00

On September 14, 2026, the U.S. District Court for the District of Massachusetts issued an order pausing the effective date of the Department of Homeland Security's Duration of Status Final Rule while litigation concerning the rule continues.

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Leave of Absence

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What Is a Leave of Absence?

A Leave of Absence (LOA) is a temporary break from academic studies due to personal, financial or health-related reasons.

In addition to declaring a Leave of Absence with their academic department, F-1 and J-1 international students must submit the OIS Leave of Absence Request in Trojan International to ensure their SEVIS record is properly updated.

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Eligibility Requirements for a L

To qualify to take a Leave of Absence, student

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Ineligible Reasons for a Leave of Absence

First-Semester Students

Late-Semester Withdrawals

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Switching Degree Programs

Employment

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How to Apply for a Leave of Ab

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United States within 15 days of this date.

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Returning From a Leave of Absence

Students returning from a Leave of Absence to resume their academic program must request to regain their immigration status.

Depending on the criteria below, students will need to obtain an Initial Attendance Form I-20/DS-2019 or a SEVIS Reactivation from OIS prior to returning to the United States and resuming their studies.

F-1 Students – Option 1: Reactivation of F-1 SEVIS Record

F-1 Students – Option 2: Initial Attendance

J-1 Students

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Will a Leave of Absence negatively impact any future U.S. visa applications (e.g., H1B, Permanent Residency)?

How many Leaves of Absence am I permitted to take?

I submitted my LOA Request a few days past the first day of the semester. Since my Leave of Absence is less than five months, am I still eligible to request reactivation of my F-1 SEVIS record?

I was approved for a Leave of Absence for the previous semester and would like to extend it. What's the process?

I took a Leave of Absence, and my SEVIS re to the United States. Since I'm returning on the s d I've met the one academic year requirement p e for CPT in my first semester after returning?

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